



Ban children's ads

Google, Facebook, Microsoft etc have been urged to stop advertising to under-18s.
<http://dgit.in/oct20-63>



Facebook accused of spying

Facebook is being sued for watching Instagram users through their cameras.
<http://dgit.in/oct20-64>

Sony WH-1000XM4

Dethroning its predecessor to become the new ANC King

Two years in the making, Sony has finally launched the Sony WH-1000XM4 Noise Cancelling headphones in India. Fans of the Mark X4's predecessor, the Sony WH-1000XM3, have been waiting, with bated breath, for the imminent launch of this device. Let's find out how these cans fared in our review.

Build and design

The Mark 4 employs a classy and understated look with a matte-black exterior and copper accents. The headphones can be folded up and ear cups can be swivelled as well. The left ear cup features the USB-C port, while the right one houses the power button and a custom button. The back of the right ear cup also doubles as a capacitive touch panel for media controls on the device, which are fairly intuitive but can be slightly unresponsive at times. While we see no IP rating on these cans, something that is new is a motion sensor tucked inside the left ear cup, which is used to detect whether the headphones are off your ears or on, to auto-pause or play media.

The cushion at the top of the headphones has been trimmed down as compared to the Mark 3s. Another change is that the ear padding now has a 10 percent larger surface area. The trimmed down headband foam caused ever-present pressure point at the top of our heads, which became more apparent as time passed by. On the other hand, the urethane memory foam ear cups are exceptionally comfortable.

Inside the headphones, there's a brand new Bluetooth SoC, the lauded Sony QN1 processor, 40mm drivers, and LCP diaphragms.

Sony Headphones Connect app and other features

If you're scouring the market for a pair of wireless headphones chock full of



premium features, the Sony WH-1000XM4 may just be the holy grail. Well, almost. The headphones do miss out on an IP rating and aptX support. Sony offers deep in-app integration with these headphones, where users can access features such as Adaptive Sound Control, adjustable EQ, Ambient Sound and ANC customisability, Speak-to-Chat, Custom button control, and more. Quick Attention is available on these cans as well and allows you to have quick conversations on the fly by covering the right ear cup with your palm. Multipoint connection is, thankfully, included. This was a feature that was sorely missed on the Mark 3s and we're glad Sony included it in the Mark 4. You also get a solid battery life of about 23 hours, as per our tests.

Sound quality

The sound quality has definitely seen some subtle but welcome changes over the last model. The sonic signature has been changed from the consumer-friendly bass bias in the Mark 3s to a sound signature that is much closer to neutral in the new Mark 4. In bass-heavy tracks such as *Another One Bites the Dust* by *Queen*, the bass hits are

punchy and energetic but still don't take away from the details in the lead instruments and vocals.

In vocal-centric tracks such as *First Day of My Life* by *Bright Eyes*, there's a great deal of warmth and vocal clarity which is paired well with the sparkly quality of the finger-picked guitar. Mid-highs and highs sound crisp, detailed and mostly sibilance-free.

ANC performance

Do we have a new ANC King in town? Yes! The WH-1000XM3 were excellent at suppressing low-frequency, constant sounds. The WH-1000XM4 does that and also is able to suppress some mid-range sounds which includes some human voices, and even some of the less-noisy mechanical keyboards.

Bottomline

Sony has done it again! The company has reclaimed the title of the best-in-class noise-cancelling pair of headphones by beating

out its own Sony WH-1000XM3 headphones. And it doesn't just limit itself to that, the Sony WH-1000XM4 also features solid sound quality, tons of customisability, multipoint connection, Quick Attention, good battery life, and more. At Rs 29,990, these are definitely pricey, however, most users will definitely be satisfied with features and performance they're getting for the seemingly exorbitant price.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

HEADPHONE TYPE: Closed, dynamic | DRIVER UNIT: 40 mm, dome type (CCAW Voice coil) | MAGNET: Neodymium | DIAPHRAGM: Aluminium-coated LCP | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 4 Hz-40,000 Hz | FREQUENCY RESPONSE (BLUETOOTH): 20 Hz-20,000 Hz (44.1 kHz Sampling)/20 Hz-40,000 Hz (LDAC 96 kHz Sampling, 990 kbps) | DSEE EXTREME: Yes | PASSIVE OPERATION: Yes (Headphone cable approx. 1.2 m) | BATTERY CHARGE TIME: Approx. 3 hours | BATTERY CHARGE METHOD: USB-C | BATTERY LIFE: 30 hours (with NC on), 38 hours (with NC off) | BLUETOOTH VERSION: Version 5.0 | WIRELESS RANGE: 10 m (30 ft) | SUPPORTED AUDIO CODECS: LDAC, AAC, SBC | NOISE CANCELLING AND AMBIENT SOUND: Yes

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